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Selectable-width push plow

Abstract

A selectable-width push plow for removing snow or other material. The push plow is configurable in any one of several pre-defined blade-width blade configurations without requiring special tools or great dexterity to adjust, while also allowing for compact storage of the device. The push plow includes a plow blade having a first panel and a second panel pivotably interconnected to the first panel. The second panel is pivotable between a retracted position in which the bottom edges of the first and second panel extend transversely to one another, and an extended position in which the bottom edges of the first and second panel extend in a common direction. The push-plow further includes an adjustable-length handle extend substantially vertically the plow blade and a glide adjacent the bottom of each panel to promote gliding of push plow over concrete, macadam or another rough or uneven surface.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a national stage application of International Application No. PCT/US2020/019029, filed Feb. 20, 2020, which claims the benefit of priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119 (e) of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/807,824, filed Feb. 20, 2019, the entirety of which is hereby incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention relates generally to shovels, and more particularly, to a new and useful selectable-width shovel in the nature of a plow allowing for use as a push plow to remove snow or other material in both narrower- and broader-width passes, while also allowing for storage of the device in a compact state.

BACKGROUND

(2) Various shovels are known in the art for lifting, pushing or otherwise moving a material from one location to a second location. With respect to the shovel's blade structure, there are two main types of shovels. The first type is mainly configured for use to lift and transport material, such as dirt, and the second type is mainly configured mainly for use to push material like a plow.

(3) A common use for a shovel is use to remove snow, which can be wet, slushy, or icy, and particularly heavy, making removal of the snow by lifting undesirable. Snow removal tasks are typically conducted in cold, raining and/or snowing/sleeting environmental conditions, which is particularly unpleasant for the person performing the snow removal task. There have been attempts in the prior art to provide a user with a shovel having a broadened (wider-width) blade to increase the width of a single pass of the shovel, and thereby to remove relatively more snow in a single pass. This is intended to ultimately reduce the amount of time required to clear a given area, and thus to reduce the amount of exposure to undesirable environmental conditions. However, an increase of the blade's width that improves performance and/or suitability in wider-width areas (e.g., a driveway) correspondingly degrades performance and/or suitability in narrower-width areas

narrower than the blade (e.g., on a walkway).

(4) Additionally, increasing the blade's width may improve performance by allowing for movement/removal of more snow in a single path, but it correspondingly increases the weight of the snow being moved/removed, and thus requires more physical strength to operate. This may make the shovel more desirable for certain users with sufficient physical strength to handle the increased weight, but it correspondingly makes the shovel less desirable for those users with insufficient physical strength to handle the increased weight.

(5) Further still, shovels with broader blade widths may be more desirable during use to remove snow more quickly, but may be less desirable when not in use, as more width is required to store the wider-width shovel blade. This makes a wider-width shovel more difficult to store, and hand tools such as these are likely in storage approximately 99% or more of the time, and are likely in use approximately 1% or less of the time.

(6) What is needed is a shovel that does not require the user to lift the weight of snow or other material that allows for material removal in broader-width and narrower-width passes, and that can be stored in a compact state.

SUMMARY

(7) The present invention provides a push plow-type shovel for removing snow or other material in a user-selectable fashion, allowing for selection from among both narrower- and broader-width shovel configurations for making corresponding narrower- and broader-width passes, preferably without requiring special tools or great dexterity to adjust, while also allowing for storage of the device in a compact state.

(8) An exemplary push plow comprises: a plow blade and a handle. The plow blade comprises: a first panel having top and bottom edges, and side edges extending between the top and bottom edges; and a second panel having respective top and bottom edges, and respective side edges extending between its top and bottom edges, the second panel being pivotably interconnected to the first panel, the second panel being pivotable between a retracted position in which the bottom edges of the first and second panel extend transversely to one another, and an extended position in which the bottom edges of the first and second panel extend in a common direction. The handle is mounted to the first panel, and extends substantially vertically from the first panel when the first panel is in a substantially vertical position.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

(1) An understanding of the following description will be facilitated by reference to the attached drawings, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 is a front perspective view of a selectable-width push-plow in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the present invention, shown in its compact state;

(3) FIG. 2 is a front perspective view of the push-plow of FIG. 1, shown in its expanded state;

(4) FIG. 3 is a right-side view of the push-plow as shown in FIG. 2;

(5) FIGS. 4 and 5 are partial rear views of the push-plow as shown in FIG. 2;

(6) FIG. 6 is a right-side perspective view of the push-plow as shown in FIG. 2; and

(7) FIG. 7 is a front perspective view of an alternative embodiment of the selectable-width push-plow of the present invention, shown in its expanded state.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) The present invention provides a push plow for manual use to remove snow or other material from a surface, such as a driveway or walkway. As a push-plow-type shovel, large amounts of snow or other material can be removed without requiring the user to lift the weight of the material being removed. The push-plow is specially configured to have a multi-segment blade. The segments can

be manually manipulated easily, and in certain embodiments without the use of any tools, to place the push plow in any selected one of several configurations. Collectively, the configurations include both narrower- and broader-width configurations for making corresponding narrower- and broader-width passes with the push plow.

(9) Accordingly, the push plow may be selectively configured by the user as desired, to make relatively broader passes in wider-width areas (e.g., a driveway) when desired, or to make relatively narrower passes in narrower-width areas (e.g., a walkway) when needed. Further, the push plow may be selectively configured by the user as desired, to make relatively broader passes when the user has sufficient physical strength to move snow in a broader pass, e.g., depending upon the depth of a particular snow accumulation, or to make relatively narrower passes when the user has insufficient strength to do so. Further still, the push plow may be used in a relatively broader-blade state, and yet make also be stored in a more company states, requiring less width than the full width of the blade in its broadened state.

(10) Referring now to FIGS. 1-6, an exemplary embodiment of a selectable-width push-plow **100** in accordance with the present invention is shown. As will be appreciated from FIGS. 1-6, the exemplary push plow **100** principally includes a plow blade **20** and a handle **80**. In use, a user can grasp the handle and push the push plow **100** to cause the plow blade **20** to ride across the ground or other surface to push snow/material along and clear snow/material from the ground/surface.

(11) In accordance with the present invention, the push plow has a multi-segment plow blade. In this exemplary embodiment, the plow blade **20** includes three distinct panels **20a**, **20b**, **20c**. In this configuration, the panels may be referred to herein as a first (central) panel **20a**, a second (wing) panel, e.g., **20b**, and a third (wing) panel, e.g. **20c**. It will be appreciated that any number of two or more panels may be used, consistent with the present invention. Each panel has respective top edges **22a**, **22b**, **22c**, respective bottom edges **24a**, **24b**, **24c**, and respect side edges **26a**, **28a**, **26b**, **28b**, and **26c**, **28c**.

(12) These panels are pivotably interconnected so they can be manually manipulated relative to one another to place the push plow in any selected one of multiple configurations. For example, as best shown in FIG. 2, the first and second panels **20a**, **20b** are pivotably interconnected in this exemplary embodiment at a first pivot joint **30**. The pivot joint **30** may include a central cylindrical section **32** acting as a pivot pin passing through openings defined in both panels. The central cylindrical section **32** may terminate in front and rear annular flanges **34a**, **34b**, with or with an annular spacer between the panels. Similarly, the first panels and third **20a**, **20c** are pivotably interconnected in this exemplary embodiment at a second pivot joint **40**. The pivot joint **40** may include a central cylindrical section **42** acting as a pivot pin passing through openings defined in both panels. The central cylindrical section **42** may terminate in front and rear annular flanges **44a**, **44b**, with or with an annular spacer between the panels. Any suitable pivot joint may be used.

(13) Accordingly, the second panel **20b** is pivotably interconnected to the first panel **20a** such that the second panel **20b** is pivotable between a retracted position (shown in FIG. 1) in which the bottom edges **24a**, **24b** of the first and second panels **20a**, **20b** extend transversely to one another (an shown in FIG. 1), and an extended position (as shown in FIG. 2) in which the bottom edges **24a**, **24b** of the first and second panels **20a**, **20b** extend in a common direction, e.g., horizontally as shown in FIG. 2. As used herein, “common direction” is used to in a non-limiting sense to mean generally in the same direction, such as generally horizontally, generally vertically, or generally parallel, to indicate that the bottom edges are both in position for gliding along a ground surface that may be perfectly flat, or may not be perfectly flat, as is often the case for outdoor surfaces such as driveways and walkways on which the push plow device is intended for use.

(14) Similarly, the third panel **20c** is pivotably interconnected to the first panel **20a** such that the third panel **20c** is pivotable between a retracted position (shown in FIG. 1) in which the bottom edges **24a**, **24c** of the first and third panels **20a**, **20c** extend transversely to one another (an shown in FIG. 1), and an extended position (as shown in FIG. 2) in which the bottom edges **24a**, **24c** of

the first and third panels **20a**, **20c** extend in a common direction, e.g., horizontally as shown in FIG. 2.

(15) In this exemplary embodiment, each panel is substantially planar. More particularly, a majority of the area of each panel is planar. For example, each panel may be constructed of a lightweight and relatively rigid material, such as corrugated plastic, which is planar. In embodiments in which the panels are planar, the panels may be pivotably interconnected to one another via a simple pivot joint, e.g. of the type described above although any suitable pivot joint may be used, to cause the first and second panels, and the first and third panels, to be substantially parallel to each other in both the retracted position and the extended position. The parallel orientation, particularly in the retracted position, contributes to the compact storage of the device, and allows the first panel to support the second and third panels during use, without placing undue stress on the second and third panels or the pivot joints.

(16) Further, in this exemplary embodiment, the first and second panels are pivotably interconnected proximally to an intersection of the side and bottom edges of both panels, as best shown in FIG. 2. For example, the pivot joint **30** provides pivotable interconnection of the first panel **20a** and the second panel **20b** in the lower right hand corner of the first panel **20a**, near the intersection of side edge **26a** and bottom edge **24a** of panel **20a**, and near the intersection of side edge **28b** and bottom edge **24b** of panel **20b**. Accordingly, the first and second panels are pivotably interconnected so that the wing panels (e.g., second panel **20b**) substantially overlie (e.g., at least 25%, or at least 50% or more of the panel overlies) the first panel **20a** when in the retracted position, as shown in FIG. 1. Further, with this configuration, the second panel **20b** does not substantially overlie (e.g., at least 25%, or at least 50% or more of the panel overlies) the first panel **20a** when in the extended position, as shown in FIG. 2.

(17) In a preferred embodiment, the pivot joints **30**, **40** are spaced on the first/central panel **20a** in coordination with the heights of the wing panels **20b**, **20c**, such that the wing panels **20b**, **20c** may be pivoted into retracted positions in a common place adjacent the central panel, and such that portions of the wing panels **20b**, **20c** do not interfere with one another during pivoting

(18) In the embodiment shown in FIGS. 1-6, each wing panel **20b**, **20c** further defines an opening **50b**, **50c** spaced from the opening for the pivot joint, e.g., along its respective top edge **22b**, **22c** in a position to align with a respective locking mechanism supported on the central panel **20a** when each wing panel is in the extended position, with its respective bottom edge **24b**, **24c** extending in a common direction with the bottom edge **24a** of the central panel **20a**. The opening **50b**, **50c** may be reinforced with a plastic or metal ring, grommet, socket or the like for receiving the locking mechanism. The locking mechanism may be any suitable structure, such as a protuberance dimensioned to seat in the opening **50b**, **50c**, or, as best shown in FIG. 4, a locking pin **54a**, **54b** insertable through a corresponding opening **52b**, **52c** in the central panel **20a** and through the openings **50b**, **50c** in the wing panels **20b**, **20c** to interlock the panels and fix their relative positions, as will be appreciated from FIGS. 2 and 4. In certain embodiments, the locking pin **54a**, **54b** comprises a T-handle ball lock pin having a push-button operable to cause a ball to protrude or to be depressable relative to the surface of the pin, and one or both of the central panel **20** and wing panels **20b**, **20c** defines a socket comprising a ramp and/or shoulder that is engageable by the ball of the pin, such that when the pin **54** is seated properly in the central **20** and wing **20b/20c** panels, the ball engages the socket such that it causes the central **20** and wing **20b/20c** panels to be drawn toward and/or against one another by the action of the ball and the socket, to provide added rigidity to the plow blade **20**, in either one or both of the extended and retracted positions of the wing panels.

(19) In one embodiment, the push plow **100** may include a spring-biased mechanism for biasing the wing panels toward their extended positions. The mechanism may include springs and/or cams. In one embodiment, a torsion spring is provided at each pivot joint **30** and the spring is tensioned/biased to resist movement toward the retracted position (FIG. 1), and to urge

movement toward the extended position (FIG. 2). This can be advantageous, for example, for aiding in maintaining contact of the wing panels **20b**, **20c** with curved and/or uneven ground surfaces. in one or both of the retracted (FIG. 1) and extended (FIG. 2) positions. Accordingly, the wing panels **20b**, **20c** may be spring-biased to retain each panel in at least one of the retracted position and the extended position.

(20) As described above, the push plow **100** includes a handle **80** in addition to the plow blade. The handle **80** is mounted to the plow blade to cause it to extend substantially vertically from the plow blade with the plow blade is in a substantially vertical position. In the exemplary embodiment shown, the handle comprises is length adjustable, and includes a handle mount **82** fixedly mounted to the first panel **20a**, and a handle **84** nested with and slidable relative to the handle mount **82**, such that the handle mount and handle can be interlocked to provide a handle of a desired length. Preferably, at least one of the handle mount **82** and the handle **84** define a plurality of spaced openings **86** that may be used selectively to interlock the handle mount **82** and handle **84** in selected relative longitudinal positions.

(21) In the exemplary embodiment shown, both of the handle mount **82** and the handle **84** define a plurality of spaced openings **86**, and the push plow **100** further includes a detent mechanism for interlocking the adjustable handle **84** with the handle mount **82** fixed to the plow blade, to adjust the length of the handle. In one embodiment, the detect mechanism comprises a locking pin **88** (with a ball detent) insertable through aligned openings in the handle mount **82** and handle **84**, as best shown in FIGS. 4 and 5. In an alternative embodiment, the handle houses a button clip operable to engage aligned openings of the handle mount **82** and handle **84**. Any suitable detent mechanism may be used for this purpose.

(22) FIG. 7 is a front perspective view of an alternative embodiment of the selectable-width push-plow of the present invention, shown in its expanded state. This embodiment is similar to that of FIGS. 1-6 but has a different handle. In particularly, the canted handle **86** of FIG. 7 has a first portion **86a** configured for receipt in the handle mount **84**, and a second portion **86b** that extends in a direction at an oblique angle relative to the first portion. The angled aspect of the canted handle may contribute to use comfort during use.

(23) In both embodiments of the push plow **100** shown in FIGS. 1-7, the push plow **100** may further include a glide **90a**, **90b**, **90c** supported adjacent the bottom edge **24a**, **24b**, **24c** of each of the first, second and third panels **20a**, **20b**, **20c**. The glide **90a**, **90b**, **90c** is provided to promote gliding of the panels **20a**, **20b**, **20c** of the push plow **100** over a rough surface, such as concrete, macadam or other material from which the push plow is to be used to remove snow, etc. The glide **90a**, **90b**, **90c** may be constructed of plastic and/or have a smoothed or rounded leading edge **94** to promote gliding of the push plow **100** over the rough surface, which may be particularly helpful if the surface includes cracks and/or uneven portions.

(24) Optionally, the push plow **100** may have a metallic brace **98a**, **98b**, **98c** adjacent the bottom edges **24a**, **24b**, **24c** of each of the panels **20a**, **20b**, **20c**, which adds rigidity, as best shown. Each brace **98** may comprise a 1/8" thick L-channel aluminum with 2" legs supported along the bottom edge that supports the panels **20a**, **20b**, **20c**, pivot joints **30**, **40**, and glides **90a**, **90b**, **90c**.

(25) In use, the push plow **100** may, for example, be removed from storage in a compact configuration, as shown in FIG. 1. The push plow **100** may then be readied for use by manually manipulating the panels as desired to place the push plow in any selected one of multiple well-defined operative configurations. In the first configuration, neither wing panel **20b**, **20c** is extended (both are in the retracted position) and the push plow **100** has its narrowest width, as shown in FIG. 1. In its second configuration, one wing panel (either **20b**, **20c**) is extended (and the other is in the retracted position) so that the push plow has an intermediate width. In its third configuration, both wing panels **20b**, **20c** are extended, as shown in FIG. 2, so that the push plow has its maximum blade width. It may be desirable to operate or store the push plow in any one of these three configurations, but it may be particularly desirable to operate the push plow in the third (broadest-

width) configuration and to store the push plow in the first (narrowest-width) configuration, for compact storage.

(26) To move a wing panel **20b**, **20c** from a retracted position to an extended position, the user may simply manually grasp the corresponding wing panel and pivot it about its respective pivot joint **30**, **40** until the wing panel reaches the extended position in which the bottom edge **24b**, **24c** of the wing panel **20b**, **20c** extends in a common direction with the bottom edge **24a** of the central panel **20a**. At this point, the corresponding openings **50b**, **52b** of the first and second panels **20a**, **20b** or openings **50c**, **52c** of the first and third panels **20a**, **20c** will align. The user may then insert the locking pin **54a**, **54b** through the openings of the relevant panels to interlock the respective central and wing panels and interlock them in the desired operative position. The plow blade **20** is thereby readied for use.

(27) The handle may be adjusted by disengaging any locking pin **89** or button clip from openings **86**, and then sliding the handle **84** relative to the handle mount **82** until the openings realign at a desired handle length. The handle may then be locked into place by re-engaging any locking pin **89** or button clip in the aligned openings **86**.

(28) The push plow **100** may then be used by grasping the upper portion of the handle **84**, positioning the push plow **100** with the glide(s) **90a**, **90b**, **90c** on the ground surface to be cleared of snow, etc., and then sliding/driving/pushing the push plow **100** over the ground surface to clear it of snow, etc. If at any point it is desired to use the push plow in a configuration providing a broader or narrower-width plow blade, the panels can be manipulated as described above to place the push plow in another of its predefined operative configurations. Accordingly, the push plow may be adjusted to accommodate different users with different degrees of physical strength, or to accommodate a single user across different snowfalls or weights of snowfalls, and/or to plow wider-width or narrower-width areas, as desired. Accordingly, the push plow **100** can be used for removing snow or other material in a user-selectable fashion, allowing for selection from among both narrower- and broader-width plow blade configurations for making corresponding narrower- and broader-width passes, without requiring special tools or great dexterity to adjust.

(29) After use, the wing panels **20b**, **20c** may be manipulated in a similar manner to place the push plow into its narrowest-width configuration to allow for storage of the device in a compact state, if desired.

(30) Having thus described a few particular embodiments of the invention, various alterations, modifications, and improvements will readily occur to those skilled in the art. Such alterations, modifications, and improvements as are made obvious by this disclosure are intended to be part of this description though not expressly stated herein, and are intended to be within the spirit and scope of the invention. Accordingly, the foregoing description is by way of example only, and not limiting. The invention is limited only as defined in the following claims and equivalents thereto.

Claims

1. A push plow comprising: a plow blade, the plow blade comprising: a first panel having top and bottom edges, and side edges extending between the top and bottom edges; a second panel having respective top and bottom edges, and respective side edges extending between its top and bottom edges, the second panel being pivotably interconnected to the first panel to pivot about an axis extending transversely to a front surface of the second panel, the second panel being pivotable about the transversely-extending axis between a retracted position in which the bottom edges of the first and second panel extend transversely to one another and a major portion of the second panel overlies the first panel, and an extended position in which the bottom edges of the first and second panel extend in a common direction and the major portion of the second panel does not overlie the first panel; and a handle mounted to the first panel, the handle extending substantially vertically from the first panel when the first panel is in a substantially vertical position.

2. The push plow of claim 1, wherein the first panel and the second panel are substantially planar.
3. The push plow of claim 2, wherein the first panel and the second panel are pivotably interconnected to be substantially parallel to each other in both the retracted position and the extended position.
4. The push plow of claim 1, wherein the first panel and the second panel are pivotably interconnected proximally to an intersection of the side and bottom edges of both panels.
5. The push plow of claim 1, wherein each of the first and second panels is constructed of corrugated plastic.
6. The push plow of claim 1, wherein the first and second panels are pivotably interconnected so that the second panel substantially overlies the first panel in the retracted position, and so that the second panel does not substantially overlie the first panel in the extended position.
7. The push plow of claim 1, wherein the second panel is spring-biased to retain the second panel in at least one of the retracted position and the extended position.
8. The push plow of claim 1, wherein the handle comprises: a handle mount fixedly mounted to the first panel; a handle body nest with and slidable relative to the handle mount.
9. The push plow of claim 8, wherein at least one of the handle mount and handle body define a plurality of spaced openings that may be used selectively to interlock the handle mount and handle body in selected relative longitudinal positions.
10. The push plow of claim 8, wherein both of the handle mount and handle body define a plurality of spaced openings, the push plow further comprising a detent mechanism comprising a button clip operable to engaged aligned ones of said plurality of spaced openings to interlock the handle mount and handle body in a selected relatively longitudinal position.
11. The push plow of claim 8, wherein the handle has a first portion and a second portion, and the second portion extends in a direction at an oblique angle relative to the first portion.
12. The push plow of claim 1, further comprising a glide supported on the bottom edge of each of the first and second panels to promote gliding of the push plow over a rough surface.
13. The push plow of claim 12, wherein each glide is constructed of plastic and has a smoothed leading edge to promote gliding of the push plow over the rough surface.
14. The push plow of claim 1, where the plow blade further comprises: a third panel having respective top and bottom edges, and respective side edges extending between its top and bottom edges, the third panel being pivotably interconnected to the first panel, the third panel being pivotable between a retracted position in which the bottom edges of the first and third panel extend transversely to one another, and an extended position in which the bottom edges of the first and third panel extend in a common direction.
15. A push plow comprising: a plow blade, the plow blade comprising: a first panel having top and bottom edges, and side edges extending between the top and bottom edges; a second panel having respective top and bottom edges, and respective side edges extending between its top and bottom edges, the second panel being pivotably interconnected to the first panel proximally to an intersection of the side and bottom edges of both panels, the second panel being pivotable about an axis normal to a plane of at least a portion of the first panel between a retracted position in which a majority of the second panel overlies the first panel with the bottom edges of the first and second panel extending transversely to one another, and an extended position in which the bottom edges of the first and second panel extend in a common direction; and a handle mounted to the first panel, the handle extending substantially vertically from the first panel when the first panel is in a substantially vertical position; the handle being mounted to a central portion of the first panel, the second panel being pivotably mounted to the first panel at a side portion of the first panel that is outside the central portion.
16. The push plow of claim 15, wherein the first panel and the second panel are substantially planar.
17. The push plow of claim 15, wherein each of the first and second panels is constructed of

corrugated plastic.

18. The push plow of claim 15, wherein the second panel is spring-biased to retain the second panel in at least one of the retracted position and the extended position.

19. The push plow of claim 15, further comprising a glide supported on the bottom edge of each of the first and second panels to promote gliding of the push plow over a rough surface.

20. The push plow of claim 19, wherein each glide is constructed of plastic and has a smoothed leading edge to promote gliding of the push plow over the rough surface.

21. The push plow of claim 15, where the plow blade further comprises: a third panel having respective top and bottom edges, and respective side edges extending between its top and bottom edges, the third panel being pivotably interconnected to the first panel, the third panel being pivotable between a retracted position in which the bottom edges of the first and third panel extend transversely to one another, and an extended position in which the bottom edges of the first and third panel extend in a common direction.

22. A push plow comprising: a plow blade, the plow blade comprising: a first panel having top and bottom edges, and side edges extending between the top and bottom edges; a second panel having respective top and bottom edges, and respective side edges extending between its top and bottom edges; a third panel having respective top and bottom edges, and respective side edges extending between its top and bottom edges; a first pivot joint interconnecting the first and second panels proximally to an intersection of the side and bottom edges of the first and second panels so that the second panel is pivotable about an axis normal to a plane of at least a portion of the first panel between a retracted position in which a majority of the second panel overlies the first panel and the bottom edges of the first and second panel extend transversely to one another, and an extended position in which a majority of the second panel does not overlie the first panel and the bottom edges of the first and second panel extend in a common direction; a second pivot joint interconnecting the first and third panels proximally to an intersection of the side and bottom edges of the first and third panels so that the third panel is pivotable about an axis normal to a plane of at least a portion of the first panel between a retracted position in which a majority of the third panel overlies the first panel and the bottom edges of the first and third panel extend transversely to one another, and an extended position in which a majority of the third panel does not overlie the first panel and the bottom edges of the first and third panel extend in a common direction; and a handle mounted to the first panel, the handle extending substantially vertically from the first panel when the first panel is in a substantially vertical position.

23. The push plow of claim 22, wherein the first panel, the second panel and the third panel are substantially planar.

24. The push plow of claim 22, wherein each of the first, second and third panels is constructed of corrugated plastic.

25. The push plow of claim 22, further comprising a glide supported on the bottom edge of each of the first, second and third panels to promote gliding of the push plow over a rough surface.

26. The push plow of claim 25, wherein each glide is constructed of plastic and has a smoothed leading edge to promote gliding of the push plow over the rough surface.
